Cambridge IELTS 4–21

Academic Reading — 216 Passages in Gross / Main Categories

Only broad study categories are used. Each passage is listed with Cambridge book, test and passage number. This is a study index, not an official Cambridge classification.

Main Category Summary

Main category	Passages
Environment & Nature	40
Psychology, Health & Human Behaviour	38
Technology, Transport & Engineering	28
Animals & Biology	26
Arts, Culture & Media	23
History & Archaeology	22
Education & Language	21
Business, Economics & Work	15
Science & Discovery	3

Animals & Biology — 26 passages

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
What do Whales Feel?	C4	T1	P2
Nature or Nurture?	C5	T1	P2
Advantages of Public Transport	C6	T2	P1
The Search for the Anti-aging Pill	C6	T3	P3
Let's Go Bats	C7	T1	P1
Ant Intelligence	C7	T3	P1
The Meaning and Power of Smell	C8	T2	P3
Biological Control of Pests	C8	T3	P2
Collecting Ant Specimens	C8	T3	P3
History of the Tortoise	C9	T1	P3
Tea and the Industrial Revolution	C10	T2	P1
Why Do Leaves Turn Red? / Autumn Leaves	C10	T3	P2
When Evolution Runs Backwards	C10	T4	P3
Research Using Twins	C11	T2	P1
Flying Tortoises	C12	T3	P1
The Coconut Palm	C13	T3	P1
How Baby Talk Gives Infant Brains a Boost	C13	T3	P2
The evolution of manufacturing / modern materials	C15	T2	P2
A Second Attempt at Domesticating the Tomato	C17	T2	P2
Insight or Evolution?	C17	T2	P3
The Thylacine (Tasmanian Tiger)	C17	T3	P1
Alfred Wegener: Science, Exploration and the Theory of Continental Drift	C18	T4	P3
The Industrial Revolution in Britain	C19	T1	P2
The Unselfish Gene	C19	T4	P3
A New Role for Livestock Guard Dogs	C20	T4	P3
Do Animals Dream?	C21	T1	P1

Arts, Culture & Media — 23 passages

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
Volcanoes – Earth-shattering News	C4	T3	P2
The Return of Artificial Intelligence	C5	T3	P3
The Power of the Big Screen	C6	T3	P1
The Story of Silk / Silk Road	C7	T1	P3
Land of the Rising Sun	C8	T3	P1
The Story of Silk / historical technology	C9	T3	P2
Museums of Fine Art and Their Public	C10	T2	P3
Crop-growing Skyscrapers	C11	T1	P1
The Story of Silk	C11	T3	P1
An Introduction to Film Sound	C11	T4	P1
Artificial Artists	C13	T1	P3
Bringing Cinnamon to Europe	C13	T2	P1
Book Review	C13	T4	P3
The History of the Codex / ancient books	C14	T2	P1
Culture, creativity and public life	C14	T4	P3
Nutmeg – A Valuable Spice	C15	T1	P1
Henry Moore (1898–1986)	C15	T3	P1
Urban Farming	C18	T1	P1
Conquering Earth's Space Junk Problem	C18	T1	P3
Living with Artificial Intelligence	C18	T2	P2

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
Georgia O'Keeffe	C20	T4	P1
Artificial Intelligence	C21	T1	P3
The Davies Sisters	C21	T2	P1

Business, Economics & Work — 15 passages

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
Micro-Enterprise Credit for Street Youth	C4	T3	P1
The Problem of Scarce Resources	C4	T4	P3
Delivering the Goods	C6	T1	P2
Makete Integrated Rural Transport Project	C7	T2	P3
The Life and Work of Marie Curie	C9	T4	P1
The Development of Museums	C9	T4	P3
The Context, Meaning and Scope of Tourism	C10	T3	P1
The Risks Agriculture Faces in Developing Countries	C12	T2	P1
UK Companies Need More Effective Boards of Directors	C12	T4	P3
Case Study: Tourism New Zealand Website	C13	T1	P1
Making the Most of Trends	C13	T2	P3
Motivational Factors and the Hospitality Industry	C14	T1	P3
Innovation and future technologies	C15	T4	P3
The Future of Work	C16	T1	P3
Automation and employment	C16	T4	P2

Education & Language — 21 passages

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
Visual Symbols and the Blind	C4	T1	P3
Lost for Words	C4	T2	P1
Obtaining Linguistic Data	C4	T3	P3
Johnson's Dictionary	C5	T1	P1
The Birth of Scientific English	C5	T2	P3
Early Childhood Education	C5	T3	P1
Do Literate Women Make Better Mothers?	C6	T4	P2
Education in Japan / school achievement	C8	T4	P2
Attitudes to Language	C9	T3	P1
This Marvellous Invention	C11	T3	P3
Language, invention and human communication	C11	T4	P3
What's the Purpose of Gaining Knowledge?	C12	T1	P3
The Benefits of Being Bilingual	C12	T2	P3
Silbo Gomero / whistle language	C14	T2	P2
Learning, opportunity and social background	C15	T4	P2
Changes in Reading Habits	C16	T2	P2
Language, reading and social change	C16	T4	P3
Does Education Fuel Economic Growth?	C17	T4	P2
Is the Era of Artificial Speech Translation Upon Us?	C19	T3	P3
Book Review / reading and education	C21	T3	P2
How Could Multilingualism Benefit India's Poorest Schoolchildren?	C21	T4	P2

Environment & Nature — 40 passages

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
Adults & Children – Loss of Tropical Rainforests	C4	T1	P1
The Truth About the Environment	C5	T1	P3

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
Disappearing Delta	C5	T3	P2
The Impact of Wilderness Tourism	C5	T4	P1
The Effect of Light on Plants and Animal Species	C5	T4	P3
Climate Change and the Inuit	C6	T1	P3
The True Cost of Food	C7	T2	P2
Endless Harvest	C7	T4	P2
The Little Ice Age	C8	T2	P2
Tourism and environmental impacts	C8	T4	P1
Animal and plant adaptation	C8	T4	P3
The Megafires of California	C10	T4	P1
Reducing the Effects of Climate Change	C11	T1	P3
The True Cost of Food	C11	T2	P3
Great Migrations	C11	T3	P2
Cork	C12	T1	P1
Bring Back the Big Cats	C12	T4	P2
Saving the Soil	C13	T4	P2
Saving Bugs to Find New Drugs	C14	T2	P3
Saving threatened species	C14	T4	P1
Should We Try to Bring Extinct Species Back to Life?	C15	T2	P1
Animal conservation and species protection	C15	T3	P2
The climate and human activity	C15	T4	P1
Why We Need to Protect Polar Bears	C16	T1	P1
Plant ‘Thermometer' Triggers Springtime Growth	C16	T3	P1
Palm Oil	C17	T3	P2
Bats to the Rescue	C17	T4	P1
Forest Management in Pennsylvania, USA	C18	T1	P2
Green Roofs	C18	T4	P1
The Impact of Climate Change on Butterflies in Britain	C19	T2	P1
Deep-sea Mining	C19	T3	P2
The Global Importance of Wetlands	C19	T4	P1
The K■k■p■	C20	T1	P1
To Britain – Reintroduction of Elms	C20	T1	P2
Manatees	C20	T2	P1
Can the Planet’s Coral Reefs Be Saved?	C20	T3	P2
Adapting to the Effects of Climate Change	C20	T4	P2
Why We Need Silence	C21	T2	P2
Saving the Saiga	C21	T3	P1
Water Hyacinth in Kenya	C21	T4	P1

History & Archaeology — 22 passages

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
Numeration	C6	T2	P3
Making Time for Science	C7	T1	P2
Archaeological research / ancient societies	C7	T3	P2
William Henry Perkin: The Man Who Invented Synthetic Dyes	C9	T1	P1
Is There Anybody Out There?	C9	T1	P2
Venus in Transit	C9	T2	P2
The Lapita People and Pacific Migration	C10	T3	P3
The history of an archaeological site / ancient discovery	C11	T4	P2
The Lost City	C12	T2	P2

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
Whatever Happened to the Harappan Civilisation?	C13	T3	P3
Ancient cities / archaeological evidence	C14	T3	P3
What Is Exploration?	C15	T1	P3
The White Horse of Uffington	C16	T2	P1
Roman Tunnels	C16	T3	P2
To Catch a King	C17	T1	P3
The Dead Sea Scrolls	C17	T2	P1
Stonehenge	C18	T2	P1
Archaeologists Discover Evidence of Prehistoric Island Settlers	C19	T1	P3
The Pirates of the Ancient Mediterranean	C19	T2	P2
Mapungubwe	C21	T1	P2
Rethinking the Past	C21	T2	P3
The Globemakers: The Curious Story of an Ancient Craft	C21	T3	P3

Psychology, Health & Human Behaviour — 38 passages

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
Alternative Medicine in Australia	C4	T2	P2
Play is a Serious Business	C4	T2	P3
What's So Funny?	C5	T2	P2
Greying Population Stays in the Pink	C6	T2	P2
Motivating Employees under Adverse Conditions	C6	T3	P2
Doctoring Sales	C6	T4	P1
Bullying – From Crisis Management to Prevention	C6	T4	P3
Work, organisations and human behaviour	C7	T3	P3
Effects of Noise	C7	T4	P3
Telepathy	C8	T1	P3
Children with Auditory Problems	C9	T2	P1
A Neuroscientist Reveals How to Think Differently	C9	T2	P3
Information Theory – The Big Idea	C9	T3	P3
Young Children's Sense of Identity	C9	T4	P2
The Psychology of Innovation	C10	T1	P3
Gifted Children and Learning	C10	T2	P2
Second Nature	C10	T4	P2
Collecting as a Hobby	C12	T1	P2
The Intersection of Health Sciences and Geography	C12	T3	P2
Music and the Emotions	C12	T3	P3
Why Being Bored Is Stimulating – and Useful, Too	C13	T1	P2
Oxytocin	C13	T2	P2
The Importance of Children's Play	C14	T1	P1
The Secret of Staying Young	C14	T3	P1
The Internet and human behaviour	C14	T3	P2
Drug discovery from insects	C14	T4	P2
Health, behaviour and human wellbeing	C15	T2	P3
Workplace behaviour and management	C15	T3	P3
Research into human behaviour and learning	C16	T2	P3
Medical research and human health	C16	T4	P1
Timur Gareyev – Blindfold Chess Champion	C17	T4	P3
The Case for Mixed-ability Classes	C18	T3	P3
The Growth Mindset	C18	T4	P2
Athletes and Stress	C19	T2	P3

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
An Inquiry into the Existence of the Gifted Child	C19	T3	P1
The Persistence and Peril of Misinformation	C19	T4	P2
How Stress Affects Our Judgement	C20	T1	P3
The Science of Procrastination	C20	T2	P2

Science & Discovery — 3 passages

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
How Much Higher? How Much Faster?	C4	T4	P1
Australia's Sporting Success	C6	T1	P1
An Ideal City	C18	T2	P3

Technology, Transport & Engineering — 28 passages

Topic / passage	Book	Test	Passage
The Nature and Aims of Archaeology	C4	T4	P2
Bakelite – The Birth of Modern Plastics	C5	T2	P1
Flawed Beauty: The Problem with Toughened Glass	C5	T4	P2
Why Pagodas Don't Fall Down	C7	T2	P1
Pulling Strings to Build Pyramids	C7	T4	P1
A Chronicle of Timekeeping	C8	T1	P1
Air Traffic Control in the USA	C8	T1	P2
Sheet Glass Manufacture: The Float Process	C8	T2	P1
Stepwells	C10	T1	P1
European Transport Systems 1990–2010	C10	T1	P2
The Falkirk Wheel	C11	T1	P2
Raising the Mary Rose	C11	T2	P2
The History of Glass	C12	T4	P1
Cutty Sark: The Fastest Sailing Ship of All Time	C13	T4	P1
The Growth of Bike-sharing Schemes Around the World	C14	T1	P2
Driverless Cars	C15	T1	P2
The Step Pyramid of Djoser	C16	T1	P2
Ancient engineering and construction	C16	T3	P3
The London Underground Railway	C17	T1	P1
Stadiums: Past, Present and Future	C17	T1	P2
Building the Skyline: The Birth and Growth of Manhattan's Skyscrapers	C17	T3	P3
Materials to Take Us Beyond Concrete	C18	T3	P1
The Steam Car	C18	T3	P2
How Tennis Rackets Have Changed	C19	T1	P1
Invasion of the Robot Umpires	C20	T2	P3
Frozen Food	C20	T3	P1
Robots and Us	C20	T3	P3
Ancient craft, maps and globemaking	C21	T4	P3

How to use this list

Practise one main category at a time, then move to mixed timed practice. The categories are intentionally broad, so closely related topics are kept together instead of creating many small categories.

Coverage: Cambridge IELTS 4–21, 18 books × 4 tests × 3 passages = 216 entries.